

JOSEPH MARKMAN

UX Researcher · Digital Anthropologist · Consumer Insights Specialist
josephmarkman.com · hi@josephmarkman.com · EN/FR Bilingual

Selected research portfolio — prepared for Sanofi Digital Consumer Experience Research Lead application

STUDY 01 · AI GRIEFBOTS & POSTHUMOUS CONSENT

Netnographic audit of posthumous AI discourse · 2024

Method: Netnography · NVivo-coded affinity mapping · Persona development · Journey mapping

Corpus: 50+ Reddit discussions · 500+ coded comments across r/AIEthics, r/GriefSupport, r/DeathPositive

- Produced three proto-personas (The Skeptic, The Seeker, The Traditionalist) from affinity-mapped behavioral data.
- Built a 7-stage user journey map tracing emotional arc from discovery through trauma and reckoning.
- Delivered consent-framework design recommendations aligned with GDPR/CNIL posthumous dignity requirements.

Full case study: josephmarkman.com/griefbots

STUDY 02 · AI-MEDIATED INTIMACY & PARASOCIAL RELATIONSHIPS

Diary study on SocialAI — "The Social Network for One" · 2024–2025

Method: Longitudinal diary studies · Qualitative coding · Behavioral pattern analysis

Platform: SocialAI — a platform where all social interaction is AI-generated; exceptional site for studying parasocial attachment in practice

- Traced emotional reliance and disclosure escalation patterns over time through coded diary entries.
- Identified three recurring behavioral modes: comfort-seeking, boundary dissolution, and reflexive withdrawal.
- Design directions: legible limits, graduated disclosure scaffolding, dignity-preserving disengagement pathways.

Full case study: josephmarkman.com/digital-intimacy

STUDY 03 · HYPERLOCAL HUMOR & DIGITAL COMMUNITY (@MEMESDELYON)

Mixed-methods study of a Lyon-based Instagram creator · 2023–2024

Method: Semi-structured interviews (French) · Platform metrics analysis · Thematic coding · Qualitative content analysis

- Conducted French-language creator interviews to map content strategy, audience perception, and local cultural knowledge.
- Identified the reach–reaction gap: posts requiring local knowledge to decode outperformed algorithmically broader content.
- Finding: engagement functioned as recognition — communities respond to content that reflects them, not content optimized for scale.

Full case study: josephmarkman.com/memesdelyon

METHODS ACROSS STUDIES

Netnography Diary Studies Semi-structured Interviews (EN/FR) Affinity Mapping NVivo Coding Journey Mapping Persona Development Platform Metrics Analysis Thematic Synthesis

MA Anthropology (PRECIAM), Université Lumière Lyon II, 2024 · BA Anthropology & French, Rutgers University · josephmarkman.com